



The interview process

Think of your job interview process as having four stages: introduction, skills test, compatibility, and decision-making. In this reading, you'll review the different stages to help you better prepare. Along the way, you'll learn more about Interview Warmup, a tool designed specifically to help you practice your interview skills. This is a great way to gain confidence before your actual interviews.

Interview stages

You will likely be required to go through multiple rounds of interviews. Each interview will vary in the types of questions asked and what is expected of you. Continue reading to learn about different types of interviews.

Stage 1: Introduction (resume and portfolio)

The goal of the introductory interview is for the recruiter to get to know you. They want to find out who you are and assess your background. This is your chance to shine. Have your portfolio and resume ready and be prepared to speak concisely about your qualifications, experience, and skills using specific examples.

Stage 2: The skill test interview (case study)

This is usually your second interview and it will often be conducted by a fellow data analyst or data engineer. In this interview, you will be given a technical assessment testing your SQL and programming skills. You will also be asked to complete a case

study or a behavioral test. Your potential employer wants to know if you can do the job that you're interviewing for, so they will be focused on getting you to demonstrate your skills. Make sure you're prepared with well-formed answers that highlight your technical knowledge and problem-solving skills.

Stage 3: The compatibility interview

In some cases, there will be an additional interview to determine mutual compatibility between you and the company. To give you a comprehensive idea of what the work culture is like, the interviewer might include other members of the team during this round.



Often the goal here is to determine if you are a good fit with the rest of the team that you will be working with. This might include your peers, as well as the person you might report to. As with the introductory interview, get ready to discuss yourself more in-depth, using examples from your portfolio and resume as needed.

Stage 4: Decision-making

When your last interview concludes, it's advisable to ask about next steps and a timeline of when a hiring decision will be made. Take note that the process can take anywhere from four-to six weeks as things are finalized.

You will likely receive one of three responses: an offer letter, a rejection letter, or no communication. Receiving a job offer is very exciting and something you can take pride in. However, don't feel pressured or obligated to accept the first offer you receive. Feel

free to ask for time to consider, do your research on a fair salary or benefits package, and be open-minded and willing to compromise.

Build your network

Unfortunately, there are times when you will receive a rejection. Despite any disappointments you may have, responding back with a thoughtful email will create a professional relationship with that hiring manager or company. You may even stand out in a way that might benefit your career in the long run. Generally, this email should be a short thank you letter expressing your appreciation for the opportunity and for the time they spent interviewing you.



There will even be cases where you will receive no response from the hiring manager. This doesn't necessarily mean you did not get the position and sending an inquiring follow-up email will help clear things up. However, if you indeed didn't get the position, then simply accept it and continue applying for jobs. Remember, every rejection is an opportunity to practice your interviewing skills.

Practice interview skills

Now that you've learned about the different interview stages, it's time to practice interviewing. You can get useful interview experiences by answering questions you might encounter in an actual interview.

Being enrolled in this certificate program gives you access to [Interview Warmup](#), which is a tool that helps you become more confident and comfortable throughout the interview process. Interview Warmup asks you interview questions to practice delivering your responses verbally. Your answers will be transcribed in real time, allowing you to review how you responded. In addition, Interview Warmup's machine learning algorithm can detect insights that can help you learn more about your answers and improve the way you communicate.

Here are some of the insights that Interview Warmup provides:

- **Talking points:** The tool lets you know which topics you covered in your answer, such as your experience, skills, and goals. You'll also be able to view other topics that you might want to consider covering.
- **Most-used words:** The tool highlights the words you used most often and suggests synonyms to broaden your word choices.
- **Job-related terms:** The tool highlights the words you used that are related to the role or industry in which you are preparing to work. You'll also be able to view an entire list of job-related terms that you might want to consider including in your answer.

To access Interview Warmup, follow these steps:

1. Go to grow.google/interview-warmup.
2. Click **Start practicing**.
3. Select **Data Analytics** to open an additional menu.
4. Select **Data Analytics** again as the field you wish to practice.
5. Click **Start**.

The interview lasts about 10 minutes, and the questions will vary with each attempt. During each interview session, you will be asked two background questions, one behavioral question, and two technical questions. You are encouraged to try as many practice interviews as you want. This is a great way to practice the interview tips you learned about in this course!

Key takeaways

Persistence is an important part of landing a job interview, continuing your job search, and acing the interview. Finding a job is hard work and you have plenty of resources to help guide you through the process. Keep applying and continue practicing your interviewing abilities until you find that perfect job!